

# GABON CACAO & SUGAR COMPANY SARL

Industrial Cocoa Transformation Platform  
DFI Impact Investment Opportunity

Creating Value, Creating Jobs, Zero Deforestation — Owendo, Gabon

CONFIDENTIAL | JUNE 2026

## Africa's cocoa sector exports 95% of its value to foreign processors — GCS closes that gap that gap

The structural failure of African commodity economies is not a shortage of raw material; it is the systematic export of industrial margin.

Gabon and the wider CEMAC region produce cocoa that is shipped raw to European and Asian processors, where the high-value derivatives — cocoa butter, cocoa powder, cocoa liquor — are manufactured and sold back into global supply chains at 2–4x the bean price.

**Key message: Local transformation of cocoa is the direct, bankable response to all four structural deficits simultaneously.**

| STRUCTURAL GAP      | CURRENT REALITY                             | CONSEQUENCE                                 |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Raw bean dependency | Fèves leave continent before transformation | Industrial margin captured abroad           |
| Youth unemployment  | 36.3% youth unemployment in Gabon           | Urgent need for skilled industrial jobs     |
| Total unemployment  | 20.2% overall unemployment                  | Structural pressure on public finances      |
| FX retention        | Minimal under raw-export model              | Hard-currency revenues leave with the beans |

# GCS converts raw Cameroonian and Gabonese beans into premium export ingredients from a certified industrial hub

Gabon Cacao & Sugar Company SARL (GCS) operates a licensed industrial hub in Owendo, Libreville to process cocoa into natural cocoa butter and powder (20–22% fat). GCS holds an Agricultural Technical Operating Agreement from the Gabonese Ministry of Agriculture and is registered with ANPI-Gabon.

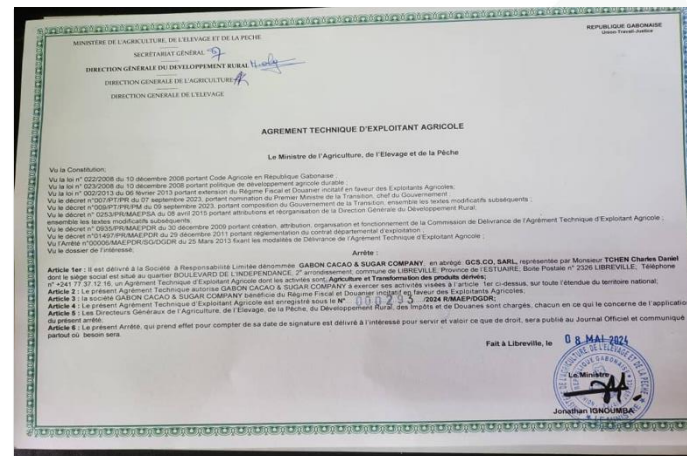
**Stage 1 Secure Supply:** Direct procurement from SCPB (Cameroon) and CAISTAB-backed Gabon cooperatives with EUDR traceability.

**Stage 2 Transform Locally:** Cleaning, roasting, grinding and pressing at Owendo.

**Stage 3 Export Globally:** FOB Libreville or CIF to markets in Europe, UK, EAEU and Middle East.

INCREMENTAL VALUE CREATED ABOVE RAW BEAN REFERENCE PRICE

**+1,300 FCFA/kg**



Official Agricultural Technical Operating Agreement from the Gabonese Ministry of Agriculture, Livestock and Fisheries

GCS owns a 5,000 m<sup>2</sup> certified site at Owendo with FCFA 1.42 billion in independently valued collateral

LAND AND FACILITY

|                    |                                  |
|--------------------|----------------------------------|
| Location           | Owendo, Quartier Akournam 1      |
| Total Site Area    | 5,000 m <sup>2</sup>             |
| Legal Title        | Titre Foncier N°8,267 (Freehold) |
| Official Valuation | FCFA 1.42 billion                |

INDUSTRIAL BUILDING

|                    |                                     |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Structure          | Q355B steel, hot-dip galvanised     |
| Construction       | Mixed masonry and steel-profile     |
| Standards          | International food-safety standards |
| Installed Capacity | 3,900 MT/year                       |

EQUIPMENT (QUOTED, CIF)

| ASSET                     | SUPPLIER           | QUOTED COST | STATUS    |
|---------------------------|--------------------|-------------|-----------|
| 2 × Diesel forklifts (3T) | Liftor Enterprises | USD 17,160  | Quoted    |
| Sinotruk HOWO 6×4 Van     | Sinotruk, China    | USD 49,900  | Quoted    |
| Processing line           | Included in CAPEX  | ~280M FCFA  | Estimated |

COLLATERAL COVERAGE RATIO

142%

The ANUTTC-valued land and built asset of FCFA 1.42 billion covers 142% of the total FCFA 1.0 billion financing requirement, providing first-ranking mortgage security for the investment loan tranche.

# GCS addresses two structurally undersupplied global cocoa ingredient markets worth USD 39.8 billion by 2032

| PRODUCT              | GLOBAL MARKET SIZE (2032) | KEY DEMAND DRIVERS                                         | GCS POSITIONING                                         |
|----------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Natural Cocoa Powder | ~USD 34.9 billion         | Beverages, bakery, confectionery, functional foods         | 20–22% fat content for premium flavour and texture      |
| Natural Cocoa Butter | ~USD 4.88 billion         | Premium chocolate, confectionery, cosmetics, personal care | Export-grade natural butter for industrial applications |

## Competitive Landscape Validation

Regional processors confirm the model's bankability. Neo Industry (Cameroon) processes 32,000 MT/year; Atlantic Cocoa (Cameroon) processes 48,000 MT/year backed by significant bank financing; Africa Processing Company (Cameroon) operates a phased two-plant model at 12,000 MT/year. **GCS enters at 3,900 MT installed capacity — a deliberately conservative and financeable scale.**

## CEMAC Advantage

Gabon and Cameroon share the CEMAC customs and monetary union framework. This enables cross-border sourcing, simplified logistics, and a unified currency (XAF/FCFA), **significantly reducing transaction and foreign exchange risk** for regional operations and export consolidation.

# Signed LOIs from Longulf and Rustaverna already cover 193% of Year-1 production capacity

## CONFIRMED FORMAL INTEREST (LOIS)

| BUYER              | JURISDICTION   | INDICATIVE ANNUAL VOLUME          | PRODUCTS       |
|--------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------|----------------|
| Longulf Trading UK | United Kingdom | 2,000 MT butter + 1,500 MT powder | Butter, powder |
| Rustaverna LLC     | Russia / EAEU  | 696 MT butter + 1,740 MT powder   | Butter, powder |

## RUSTAVERNA EAEU FACILITATION NETWORK

| COUNTERPARTY | COUNTRY | COCOA BUTTER | COCOA POWDER |
|--------------|---------|--------------|--------------|
| Stimul Group | Russia  | ~35 MT/month | ~65 MT/month |
| Bryankonfi   | Russia  | ~8 MT/month  | ~25 MT/month |
| Chocoladovo  | Belarus | ~15 MT/month | ~30 MT/month |
| Sazhinskiy   | Russia  | —            | ~15 MT/month |

## LONGULF TRADING UK LTD — CREDENTIALS

UK-incorporated commodity trading house with 40+ years of experience. Audited 2024 financial statements (Buzzacott Audit LLP) show **turnover of USD 214.3M**, **gross profit of USD 9.9M**, and **net assets of USD 30.6M** (including USD 9.9M cash). A creditworthy, audited counterparty.

## TRADE FINANCE SUPPORT

Charter Trade HCP has confirmed active discussions regarding a trade finance facility of up to **USD 5,000,000** to support working-capital and procurement cycles.



Letter of Confirmation from Charter Trade HCP

## ADDITIONAL BUYERS IN DISCUSSION

Groupe Mars (UK), Foodcom SA (Poland), White Amber (Estonia), Zocoa Chocolat (UAE), CocoaHub (UK), McCormick & Company (Mexico), Huyser Möller B.V. (Netherlands), Protect First AG (Liechtenstein).

# A simple, high-margin model — buy beans at 1,500 FCFA/kg, sell ingredients at 2,800 FCFA/kg 2,800 FCFA/kg equivalent

## YEAR 1 BASE-CASE REVENUE BUILD

Based on 1,000 MT throughput

| PRODUCT              | OUTPUT | PRICE (USD) | REVENUE (FCFA) |
|----------------------|--------|-------------|----------------|
| Natural Cocoa Butter | 324 MT | \$8,500/MT  | 1,652,400,000  |
| Natural Cocoa Powder | 490 MT | \$4,000/MT  | 1,176,000,000  |
| Total                | 814 MT |             | 2,828,400,000  |

### Conservative Price Assumptions

Cocoa butter: USD 8,500/MT (market range 2025–2026: USD 7,500–11,000/MT)

Cocoa powder: USD 4,000/MT (market range 2025–2026: USD 3,200–5,000/MT)

## COST STRUCTURE (YEAR 1)

RAW BEAN PROCUREMENT

**1,500,000,000 FCFA**

1,000 MT × 1,500 FCFA/kg

GROSS PROFIT (BEFORE OPEX)

**1,328,400,000 FCFA**

GROSS MARGIN

**47%**

### OPEX Breakdown: 497,100,420 FCFA

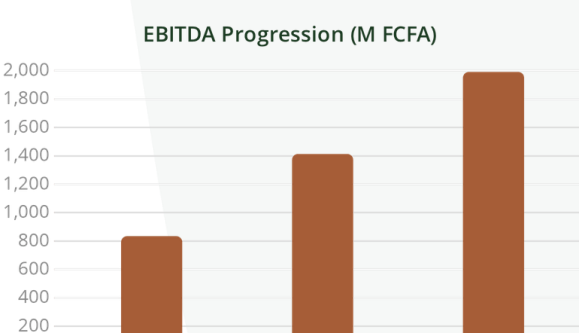
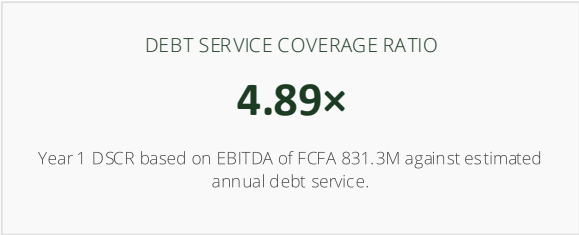
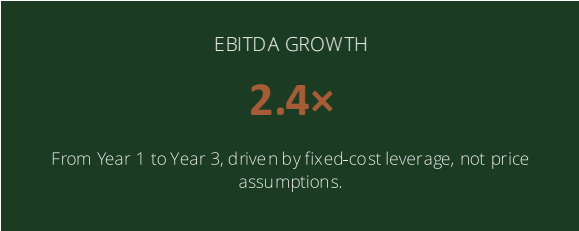
Includes labour, energy, maintenance, quality control, insurance, and administration. OPEX scales at ~17% per year as throughput increases, reflecting fixed-cost leverage.

### Supplier Invoice Finance

90,000,000 FCFA in Year 1 (6% p.a.), rising proportionally with throughput.

# EBITDA grows 2.4× from Year 1 to Year 3 as fixed-cost leverage drives margin expansion

| METRIC                       | YEAR 1        | YEAR 2        | YEAR 3        |
|------------------------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
| Throughput (MT)              | 1,000         | 1,500         | 2,000         |
| Total Revenue (FCFA)         | 2,828,400,000 | 4,242,600,000 | 5,656,800,000 |
| Revenue (USD equivalent)     | ~4,714,000    | ~7,071,000    | ~9,428,000    |
| Bean Procurement Cost (FCFA) | 1,500,000,000 | 2,250,000,000 | 3,000,000,000 |
| Gross Profit (FCFA)          | 1,328,400,000 | 1,992,600,000 | 2,656,800,000 |
| Gross Margin                 | 47%           | 47%           | 47%           |
| OPEX (FCFA)                  | 497,100,420   | 582,815,680   | 669,146,693   |
| EBITDA (FCFA)                | 831,299,580   | 1,409,784,320 | 1,987,653,307 |
| EBITDA Margin                | 29.4%         | 33.2%         | 35.1%         |
| Finance Cost (6%)            | 90,000,000    | 135,000,000   | 180,000,000   |
| Profit Before Tax (FCFA)     | 741,299,580   | 1,274,784,320 | 1,807,653,307 |





# Every stress scenario maintains positive EBITDA — the model is structurally robust

## YEAR 1 EBITDA SENSITIVITY ANALYSIS

| STRESS SCENARIO              | EBITDA (FCFA) | VS. BASE CASE |
|------------------------------|---------------|---------------|
| Base case                    | 890,298,580   | —             |
| Bean price +15%              | 665,298,580   | -25%          |
| Cocoa butter price -10%      | 725,058,580   | -19%          |
| Utilisation at 75% of target | 558,198,580   | -37%          |
| Logistics costs +20%         | 845,298,580   | -5%           |
| USD appreciation +10%        | 1,173,138,580 | +32%          |

### KEY OBSERVATION

Even under the most adverse single-factor scenario (75% utilisation), EBITDA remains positive at FCFA 558M — well above the annual debt service obligation. The model does not require full-capacity operation to service debt.

## AGRICULTURAL TAX REGIME ADVANTAGES

| TAX                        | STATUS     | CASH FLOW IMPACT                                 |
|----------------------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Corporate income tax (IS)  | Exe mpt    | Saves up to 30% of PBT — supports debt repayment |
| Business licence (Patente) | Exe mpt    | Reduces fixed overhead                           |
| VAT                        | Exe mpt    | Optimises export cash flow                       |
| Import duties on machinery | Exe mpt    | Reduces CAPEX by ~10-15%                         |
| Social solidarity (CSS)    | Applicable | 1% of turnover                                   |
| Personal income tax (IRPP) | Applicable | Neutral on margin                                |

FCFA 1.0 billion total requirement, secured by FCFA 1.42 billion in certified collateral — 142% coverage

SOURCES AND USES OF CAPITAL

| USE OF PROCEEDS                                 | AMOUNT (FCFA) | % OF TOTAL |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------|
| Processing line and industrial equipment        | 280,000,000   | 28.9%      |
| Building construction and assembly              | 175,000,000   | 18.0%      |
| Logistics fleet and vehicles                    | 165,000,000   | 17.0%      |
| Installation, commissioning, and contingencies  | 90,000,000    | 9.3%       |
| Working capital — initial raw material sourcing | 200,000,000   | 20.6%      |
| Gensets and technical installations             | 25,000,000    | 2.6%       |
| Quality laboratory and control equipment        | 10,000,000    | 1.0%       |
| Furniture, IT, and administration equipment     | 25,000,000    | 2.6%       |
| Total                                           | 970,000,000   | 100%       |

PROPOSED CAPITAL STRUCTURE

| TRANCHE                                  | AMOUNT (FCFA) | SECURITY                                                           |
|------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Investment loan                          | 800,000,000   | First-ranking mortgage on Titre Foncier N°8,267 + equipment pledge |
| Working-capital / campaign facility      | 200,000,000   | Stock pledge (tierce détention) + cash flow domiciliation          |
| Total debt                               | 1,000,000,000 |                                                                    |
| Collateral (ANUTTC valuation, June 2026) | 1,420,000,000 |                                                                    |
| Collateral coverage ratio                | 142%          |                                                                    |

TRADE FINANCE OVERLAY

Charter Trade HCP is in active discussions to provide a complementary USD 5,000,000 trade finance facility to support procurement cycles between bean purchase and product export receipts, reducing working-capital pressure on the core lending structure.

## Six layers of de-risking protect investor capital across commodity, market, regulatory, and operational dimensions

| RISK CATEGORY                | RISK                                      | MITIGATION                                                                                                                                                                              |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Commodity price risk         | Cocoa bean and product price volatility   | Hedging account established with Attara (Foenix Partners Ltd, FCA-regulated); <b>STONEX</b> professional trading infrastructure onboarded.                                              |
| Offtake / market risk        | Inability to sell product                 | <b>Longulf LOI</b> (2,000 MT butter + 1,500 MT powder); <b>Rustaverna EAEU network</b> (indicative 58 MT/month butter + 135 MT/month powder); 8 additional buyers in active discussion. |
| Supply / sourcing risk       | Insufficient raw material supply          | <b>SCPB Cameroon</b> supply contract; CAISTAB-backed Gabonese cooperatives; contingency relationships with COCOBOD (Ghana) and São Tomé contacts.                                       |
| Regulatory / compliance risk | EUDR deforestation regulation             | Signed <b>EUDR compliance agreement</b> in place; traceability system embedded in sourcing protocol; Longulf LOI explicitly acknowledges EUDR requirements.                             |
| Collateral / credit risk     | Insufficient security for lender          | ANUTTC-valued land and built asset at <b>FCFA 1.42B (142% of total financing)</b> ; first-ranking mortgage; equipment pledge; stock pledge on working-capital facility.                 |
| Operational risk             | Plant commissioning or production failure | Technical Manager Mohamed Diarrassouba brings <b>15+ years ex-Barry Callebaut</b> plant management experience; STL-designed 35×60×8m Q355B steel facility to food-safety standards.     |

# GCS delivers quantifiable development impact across employment, trade, and sustainability dimensions

## SDG ALIGNMENT

| SDG                           | INDICATOR                                 | GCS CONTRIBUTION                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| SDG 8 — Decent Work           | Direct jobs created                       | 30–50 skilled industrial, logistics, and management roles at commissioning; scaling to 100+ at full capacity                 |
| SDG 9 — Industry & Innovation | First industrial cocoa processor in Gabon | Establishes a replicable model for CEMAC-region value-added processing                                                       |
| SDG 10 — Reduced Inequalities | Smallholder income uplift                 | SCPB farmer network (32 registered producers) and CAISTAB-backed Gabonese cooperatives receive premium prices vs. raw export |
| SDG 13 — Climate Action       | Zero-deforestation supply chain           | EUDR-compliant sourcing; Rainforest Alliance certification targeted 2027                                                     |
| SDG 17 — Partnerships         | Institutional engagement                  | Active at ACFIF 2026; engagement with ICE Benchmark President; Chocoa Amsterdam 2026                                         |

### HARD-CURRENCY EXPORT IMPACT

**~USD 9.4M**

Annual export revenues generated at Year 3 throughput of 2,000 MT — a meaningful contribution to Gabon's non-oil export diversification agenda.

### Farmer Network

The SCPB supply base includes 32 registered smallholder producers in Cameroon, with a transition plan to integrate Gabonese producers through the CAISTAB framework as domestic supply matures.

# An experienced, internationally credentialed team with the operational depth to execute at industrial scale

## EXECUTIVE TEAM

### Charles-Daniel Tchen

#### FOUNDER & CEO

Expert in agricultural commodity trading and CEMAC regional logistics. Specialist in trade finance structuring and international banking negotiations. BSc in International Business, Brunel University London. Active speaker at ACFIF 2026 and Chocoo Amsterdam 2026.

### Mohamed Diarrassouba

#### TECHNICAL MANAGER

15+ years of industrial cocoa plant management experience, including senior roles at Barry Callebaut. Expert in maintenance management, utilities, and industrial process optimisation. Specialist in CAPEX planning, QA/HSE standards, and food safety certification.

## NON-EXECUTIVE DIRECTORS

### Charles Tchen

#### NON-EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

Former Delegated General Manager of Shell Gabon. 30+ years of large-scale industrial leadership in Gabon. Honorary Consul of the Netherlands in Gabon. Mechanical Engineer (RWTH Aachen).

### William Bruce-Vanderpuye III

#### NON-EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

Expert in international energy and commodity trading. Specialist in complex trade finance structuring and cross-border market entry. Extensive emerging-market operations experience.

## A phased commissioning and scale-up plan delivers measurable milestones against each tranche each tranche of capital

| PHASE          | TIMELINE   | MILESTONE                                                                         | FINANCIAL TRIGGER                                   |
|----------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Commissioning  | Q3-Q4 2026 | Full commissioning of 3,900 MT Owendo facility; first export shipments            | Loan drawdown — investment tranche                  |
| Ramp-Up        | Q1-Q2 2027 | 1,000 MT throughput achieved; EUDR and Rainforest Alliance certification          | Working-capital facility activation                 |
| Optimisation   | Q3-Q4 2027 | 85% capacity utilisation; operational break-even; expansion of offtake agreements | First debt service payments from operating cashflow |
| Transformation | 2028       | Launch of secondary processing (industrial chocolate); CEMAC market entry         | Reinvestment from retained earnings                 |

### LONG-TERM VISION

Establish GCS as the Central African cocoa processing hub, scaling to 4,400 MT by Year 5 and positioning Gabon as a net exporter of value-added cocoa ingredients rather than raw beans.

# A de-risked, DFI-aligned opportunity to finance inclusive industrialisation in Gabon

## INVESTMENT SUMMARY

|                             |                                                                |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Total financing required    | FCFA 1.0 billion (~USD 1.67 million)                           |
| Proposed structure          | FCFA 800M investment loan + FCFA 200M working-capital facility |
| Complementary trade finance | USD 5M (Charter Trade HCP, in discussion)                      |
| Collateral                  | FCFA 1.42B (142% coverage) — Titre Foncier N°8,267 + equipment |
| Year-1 DSCR                 | 4.89×                                                          |
| Year-1 EBITDA               | FCFA 831 M (~USD 1.39M)                                        |
| Year-3 EBITDA               | FCFA 1.99B (~USD 3.31M)                                        |
| Gross margin                | 47% (all years)                                                |
| EBITDA growth               | 2.4× (Year 1 to Year 3)                                        |
| Impact credentials          | SDG 8, 9, 10, 13, 17 — EUDR compliant — zero deforestation     |

Charles-Daniel Tchen

FOUNDER & CEO

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📍 Libreville, Gabon

### GABON CACAO & SUGAR COMPANY SARL

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Owendo, Libreville, Gabon

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*All financial projections are based on the BGR Bank investment dossier (June 2026). Longulf LOI and Charter HCP letter are non-binding expressions of commercial interest. Rustaverna letter is a facilitation support document, not a binding purchase commitment. ANUTTC valuation dated June 2026.*